

Sample Superstore Dataset

Data Dictionary & Basic Data Profiling Report

July 3, 2026

Overview

This document provides a complete data dictionary for the `Sample_Superstore.csv` dataset, along with the results of a basic data profiling exercise (Section 2.5). The dataset contains U.S. retail order-level transaction records, including customer, geography, product, and financial (sales/profit) information.

1 Dataset Summary

Attribute	Value
File name	Sample__Superstore.csv
Total rows (records)	9,994
Total columns (fields)	19
Grain of the table	One row = one product line item within an order
Date range covered	Jan 03, 2014 – Dec 30, 2017
Missing / null values	None (0 nulls across all columns)
Country	United States (single country)

2 Data Dictionary

The table below documents every column in the dataset: its data type, a description, and example/observed values.

Column Name	Data Type	Description	Example / Notes
Row ID	Integer	Unique sequential identifier for each row in the file (not a business key).	1, 2, 3, ... 9994
Order ID	String	Unique identifier for a customer order. A single order can span multiple rows if it contains multiple products.	CA-2016-152156
Order Date	Date	Date the order was placed by the customer.	11-08-2016 (mixed MM-DD-YYYY / M/D/YYYY formats)

Column Name	Data Type	Description	Example / Notes
Ship Date	Date	Date the order was shipped to the customer.	11-11-2016
Ship Mode	Categorical (String)	Shipping method selected for the order.	Standard Class, Second Class, First Class, Same Day
Customer ID	String	Unique identifier for the customer who placed the order.	CG-12520
Segment	Categorical (String)	Market segment the customer belongs to.	Consumer, Corporate, Home Office
Country	Categorical (String)	Country where the order was shipped.	United States (constant – only 1 value)
City	Categorical (String)	City where the order was shipped.	Henderson, Los Angeles, ... (531 unique)
State	Categorical (String)	U.S. state where the order was shipped.	Kentucky, California, ... (49 unique)
Region	Categorical (String)	Sales region grouping of states.	South, West, Central, East
Product ID	String	Unique identifier for the product ordered.	FUR-BO-10001798
Category	Categorical (String)	Top-level product category.	Furniture, Office Supplies, Technology
Sub-Category	Categorical (String)	Second-level, more granular product classification within a Category.	Bookcases, Chairs, Labels, Tables, Storage, Furnishings, Art, Phones, Binders, Appliances, Paper, Accessories, Envelopes, Fasteners, Supplies, Machines, Copiers (17 total)
Product Name	String	Full descriptive name of the product.	“Bush Somerset Collection Bookcase”
Sales	Float (currency, USD)	Total sale (revenue) amount for that line item.	Range: \$0.44 – \$22,638.48; Mean $\approx$ \$229.86
Quantity	Integer	Number of units of the product ordered in that line item.	Range: 1 – 14; Mean $\approx$ 3.79
Discount	Float (proportion)	Discount applied to the line item, expressed as a decimal fraction (0 = no discount).	Range: 0.0 – 0.8; Mean $\approx$ 0.16
Profit	Float (currency, USD)	Profit (or loss, if negative) earned on that line item after discount and cost.	Range: -\$6,599.98 – \$8,399.98; Mean $\approx$ \$28.66

3 2.5 Basic Data Profiling

The following questions were answered directly from the raw `.csv` file (using `pandas` for verification) without building any analysis or model on top of it.

Q1. How many rows are there?

There are **9,994 rows** (excluding the header row). Each row represents a single product line item within a customer order.

Q2. How many columns are there?

There are **19 columns**, covering order details, customer info, geography, product info, and sales/financial metrics.

Q3. How many unique customers?

There are **793 unique customers**, identified by the `Customer ID` column.

Q4. How many states?

Orders were shipped to **49 unique U.S. states** (all states except one are represented in the data).

Q5. How many product categories?

There are **3 product categories**.

Q6. What are the category names?

The three categories are:

- Furniture
- Office Supplies
- Technology

(Each category is further broken down into 17 total Sub-Categories, e.g. Chairs, Phones, Binders, Copiers, etc.)

Q7. What customer segments exist?

There are **3 customer segments**:

- Consumer
- Corporate
- Home Office

Q8. Which column seems to be the most important?

Sales (and closely related, **Profit**) appears to be the most important column. This is because:

- It is the core business metric the entire dataset revolves around – a retail transaction dataset exists primarily to analyze revenue.
- Nearly every other column (Category, Sub-Category, Region, Segment, Discount, Ship Mode, dates) functions as a *dimension* that Sales/Profit can be sliced and aggregated by.
- Profit is arguably equally critical for business decision-making since it reveals whether high sales volume actually translates into a healthy margin (e.g., after accounting for Discount) – some sub-categories can have high Sales but negative Profit.
- Together, `Order ID` and `Customer ID` are the most important *keys* (structural columns), but **Sales** is the most important *measure* for analysis.

4 Additional Profiling Notes (Supplementary)

A few extra facts surfaced during profiling that are useful context for further analysis:

- Number of unique orders: **5,009** (an order can contain multiple product line items, hence more rows than orders).
- Number of unique products: **1,862**.
- Number of unique cities: **531**.
- Number of regions: **4** (South, West, Central, East).
- Number of shipping modes: **4** (Standard Class, Second Class, First Class, Same Day).
- Total Sales across all rows: approximately **\$2,297,200.86**.
- Total Profit across all rows: approximately **\$286,397.02**.
- No missing/null values were found in any column.
- **Order Date** and **Ship Date** are stored as text in mixed date formats (e.g., 11-08-2016 and 6/16/2016) and should be parsed/standardized before any time-series analysis.